DESCRIPTION OF COURSEWORK

Course Code	MPU1052
Course Name	Malaysia Citra
Lecturer	Ms. Nursyahida Mohd Jaafar & Ms. Nurul Hafeeza Juma'ah
Academic Session	September 2026
Assessment Title	Malaysia Through Global Eyes: Understanding, Valuing and Our Commitment
Assessment Method	Malaysia Citra - Written Assessment
Teaching & Learning Method	Structured Discussion
CLO2 (A3 – Valuing)	Explain Malaysia's culture, political and economic transformation in fostering sustainable development.
PLO	PLO4 – Interpersonal Skills

A. Purpose of the Assessment

This group written assignment requires students to examine Malaysia's cultural, political, and economic transformation and its relationship to sustainable development. Students will analyse relevant developments in Malaysian society, consider intercultural and international perspectives, and collectively evaluate practices or approaches that may contribute to Malaysia's future development.

The assignment should demonstrate the group's ability to explain relevant transformations, compare perspectives, make reasoned collective judgements, and support its arguments with appropriate examples and credible academic evidence.

B. Course Learning Outcomes (CLO) covered

At the end of this assessment, students are able to:

CLO 2 Explain Malaysia's culture, political and economic transformation in fostering sustainable development.

C. University Policy on Academic Misconduct

1. Academic misconduct is a serious offense in Xiamen University Malaysia. It can be defined as any of the following:
   i. **Plagiarism** is submitting or presenting someone else's work, words, ideas, data or information as your own intentionally or unintentionally. This includes incorporating published and unpublished material, whether in manuscript, printed or electronic form into your work without acknowledging the source (the person and the work).
   ii. **Collusion** is two or more people collaborating on a piece of work (in part or whole) which is intended to be wholly individual and passed it off as own individual work.
   iii. **Cheating** is an act of dishonesty or fraud in order to gain an unfair advantage in an assessment. This includes using or attempting to use, or assisting another to use materials that are prohibited or inappropriate, commissioning work from a third party, falsifying data, or breaching any examination rules.

2. All assessments submitted must be the student's own work, without any materials generated by AI tools, including direct copying and pasting of text or paraphrasing. Any form of academic misconduct, including using prohibited materials or inappropriate assistance, is a serious offense and will result in a zero mark for the entire assessment or part of it. If more than one party is involved, such as in the case of collusion, all parties will receive the same penalty.

D. Instruction to Students

This group written assignment requires students to explore Malaysia's cultural, political, and economic transformation in fostering sustainable development. Students will work collaboratively to examine how selected transformations have influenced Malaysian society and development.

Drawing on the diverse cultural and national perspectives represented within the group, students should exchange perspectives, compare experiences and make reasoned collective judgements about Malaysia's transformation and future development. The assignment should demonstrate collaborative discussion, intercultural engagement, collective valuing and evidence-based judgement.

Evaluation Breakdown

No.	Component Title	Percentage (%)
1.	Section 1: Cultural Transformation in Malaysia	20
2.	Section 2: Political and Economic Transformation in Malaysia	20
3.	Section 3: Malaysia and Sustainable Development	20
4.	Section 4: Intercultural Perspectives and Collective Evaluation	20
5.	Academic Quality and Formatting	10
6.	**Written Assignment Subtotal**	90
7.	Peer Evaluation	10
	TOTAL	**100**

E. TASK(S)

General Instructions

Students are required to complete **ALL FOUR (4) sections** of this assignment.

Students must demonstrate an understanding of Malaysia's cultural, political, and economic transformations and their relationships with sustainable development. Discussions should go beyond factual descriptions by incorporating relevant explanations, critical analysis, evaluation, and evidence-based arguments.

All four sections must be completed as **ONE integrated group assignment**, with appropriate headings and subheadings to distinguish the different areas of discussion.

Students are expected to support their discussions with relevant Malaysian examples, credible academic sources, and appropriate evidence.

Section 1: Cultural Transformation in Malaysia (20 Marks)

Discuss selected examples of cultural transformation in Malaysia.

Explain how Malaysian culture has developed or adapted in response to social changes, cultural diversity, modernisation, and/or global influences.

Evaluate the significance of these transformations for contemporary Malaysian society and their contributions to sustainable development.

Section 2: Political and Economic Transformation in Malaysia (20 Marks)

Discuss selected political and economic transformations that have contributed to Malaysia's development.

Explain how these transformations have influenced Malaysian society and evaluate their significance for the country's continuing development.

Your discussion must establish meaningful connections between political and/or economic transformations and sustainable development.

Important: Avoid merely listing historical events, government policies, or economic achievements without providing relevant explanations, analysis, and evaluation.

Section 3: Malaysia and Sustainable Development (20 Marks)

Identify **TWO (2) current development priorities, challenges, or approaches** that your group considers important for Malaysia's sustainable future.

For each selected priority, challenge, or approach:

1. Explain its importance to Malaysia's sustainable development.
2. Analyse how cultural, political, and/or economic factors may support or hinder progress.
3. Evaluate its implications for Malaysia's future development.
4. Support your discussion with relevant Malaysian examples and credible evidence.

Your discussion should demonstrate a clear understanding of Malaysia's current development needs and the factors influencing its sustainable future.

Section 4: Intercultural Perspectives and Collective Evaluation (20 Marks)

Drawing on the different cultural and national backgrounds represented within your group, select **TWO (2) to THREE (3) meaningful international perspectives, practices, or experiences** that provide useful comparisons with Malaysia.

Your discussion must:

1. Explain the selected international perspectives, practices, or experiences and their relevance to Malaysia.
2. Compare and evaluate what Malaysia could reasonably learn from these perspectives in relation to cultural, political, economic, and/or sustainable development.
3. Assess their suitability for the Malaysian context by considering relevant cultural, social, political, and/or economic differences.
4. Explain how these perspectives or practices could be adapted to Malaysia's circumstances rather than simply adopted without modification.

5. Present a **collective group evaluation and judgement** based on the exchange of ideas and perspectives among group members.

Important: This section is **NOT intended to be a separate description of each group member's home country**.

Instead, students must demonstrate meaningful intercultural discussion, collaborative evaluation, and a shared group judgement regarding what Malaysia could learn from international experiences.

F. FORMAT AND SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Students are required to follow the formatting guidelines and include all compulsory components outlined below. Failure to comply with these requirements may result in mark deductions in accordance with the assessment guidelines.

1. GENERAL FORMATTING REQUIREMENTS

a. Font Type

- Times New Roman must be used throughout the assignment.

b. Font Size

- **14 pt:** Main title, topic, and headings.
- **12 pt:** Main content and discussion.

c. Margins and Text Alignment

- **Margins:** Use Normal margins (2.54 cm / 1 inch on all sides).
- **Text Alignment:** All paragraphs must be justified (aligned evenly along both the left and right margins).

d. Line Spacing

- Use **1.5 line spacing** throughout the assignment.

e. Page Limit

- The written assignment must be **between 20 and 25 pages ONLY**.
- The following sections are excluded from the page count:
    - Cover Page
    - Declaration Form
    - Table of Contents

    - List of References
    - Appendices
    - Marking Rubric
    - Turnitin Report
- Students who wish to exceed the maximum page limit must obtain **prior approval from their respective lecturer**.

f. Page Numbering

- Page numbers must follow the format illustrated in the example provided below.

Page 1 of 8

- Ensure that page numbering is consistent throughout the assignment.

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2. COVER PAGE AND DECLARATION FORM

- The assignment must include the **official Cover Page and Declaration Form**.
- Both documents can be downloaded from Moodle.
- Students must complete all required information accurately, including their names and student IDs.
- All group members must sign the Declaration Form.

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3. ASSIGNMENT TOPIC

- Students are required to develop an appropriate and relevant title that reflects the overall focus of the written assignment.
- The title should represent the key themes of **Malaysia's cultural, political, and economic transformation, sustainable development, and intercultural perspectives**.
- The selected title must be relevant to the assignment requirements and reflect the discussions presented in all four compulsory sections.

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4. ASSIGNMENT STRUCTURE AND CONTENT

The written assignment must include the following sections in the order presented below.

a. Table of Contents

- A Table of Contents is **COMPULSORY**.
- Include all main sections, subheadings, and their corresponding page numbers.

- Ensure that the page numbers are accurate and consistent with the assignment.

b. Introduction

- Provide a clear introduction to the overall topic of the assignment.
- Briefly explain the background, context, and main focus of the discussion.
- Introduce the key themes of cultural, political, and economic transformation, sustainable development, and intercultural perspectives.
- Provide a brief overview of the main areas that will be discussed in the assignment.

c. Main Discussion (Content)

- The Main Discussion must address **ALL FOUR (4) compulsory sections** outlined in Part E: Task(s).
- Students must organise their discussion using appropriate headings and subheadings corresponding to each section.
- Present a well-organised and comprehensive discussion that addresses all assignment requirements.
- Students are expected to demonstrate **critical thinking, analysis, and evaluation**, rather than merely describing facts or listing information.
- All discussions must be supported by relevant Malaysian examples, credible evidence, and appropriate academic sources.
- **In-text citations are COMPULSORY** whenever information, arguments, or ideas from other sources are used.
- Students must ensure that their discussions are relevant, logically connected, and supported by appropriate explanations and evidence.
- Avoid unnecessary repetition of information across the four sections.

d. Conclusion

- Provide an overall conclusion based on the discussions presented in all four sections.
- Summarise the main findings and arguments regarding Malaysia's transformation and sustainable development.
- Highlight the significance of the discussions for Malaysia's present and future development.
- The conclusion must reflect the overall findings of the assignment and should not introduce new information.

e. List of References

- Students must include a **minimum of TEN (10) credible reference sources**.
- All references must follow either **APA 6th or APA 7th edition**, applied consistently throughout the assignment.
- Students may refer to the following guide for assistance:

  https://www.mendeley.com/guides/APA-citation

- **The following sources are NOT permitted:**
    - Wikipedia
    - Unofficial or unreliable websites
    - Anonymous blogs
- All sources cited in the assignment must be included in the List of References.
- Similarly, all sources listed in the References must be cited in the assignment.

f. Appendices

- Pictures and photographs are **NOT ALLOWED** in the Main Discussion section.
- Only relevant tables, charts, and graphs that directly support the discussion are permitted in the Main Discussion section.
- All additional pictures, photographs, and supporting materials must be placed in the **Appendices section**.
- Supporting materials may include:
    - Photographs
    - Newspaper excerpts
    - Survey links
    - Interview links
    - Other relevant supporting documents
- All materials must be appropriately labelled and acknowledged.
- All materials included in the Appendices must be relevant to the assignment and referred to in the Main Discussion where appropriate.

g. Marking Rubric

- Students must include the **official marking rubric provided for the current semester**.
- The complete marking rubric must be attached to the assignment submission.
- Students are advised to review the marking rubric carefully to understand the assessment criteria.

h. Turnitin Report

- A **Turnitin Report is COMPULSORY** and must be included in the assignment submission.
- Students must ensure that their work complies with the plagiarism and AI-generated content requirements established for the current semester.
- The permitted similarity score and AI-generated content indicator must **not exceed 25% each**, in accordance with the course requirements.
- Failure to include the Turnitin Report will result in a **deduction of TEN (10) marks**.
- Further details regarding Turnitin requirements will be provided separately.

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5. IMPORTANT REMINDERS AND ASSESSMENT REQUIREMENTS

a. Group Assignment Requirements

- **ONE (1) written assignment must be submitted per group.**
- This is a group-based assessment. Students are **NOT required to submit a separate individual reflection**.
- All group members are expected to participate meaningfully in the discussion, research, evaluation, and preparation of the written assignment.
- Group members are responsible for ensuring that the final submission meets all assignment requirements.
- The assignment should demonstrate collaboration, particularly in Section 4, where students are required to exchange intercultural perspectives and develop a collective group evaluation.

Students are expected to present their work professionally and follow all formatting and submission requirements outlined in this document.

c. Peer Evaluation

- Peer Evaluation carries **TEN (10) marks** and is assessed individually.
- Each group member will be evaluated based on their contribution, cooperation, responsibility, and active participation throughout the assignment process.
- Students are expected to contribute fairly and meaningfully to the completion of the group assignment.
- **Peer evaluation marks may differ among group members**, depending on their respective contributions and participation.
- The peer evaluation link will be made available at a later date (week 10), and further instructions will be announced during class.

e. Submission Requirements

Before submitting the assignment, students must ensure that:

1. All compulsory sections and supporting documents are included.
2. The Main Discussion addresses **ALL FOUR (4) sections** outlined in Part E: Task(s).
3. The assignment follows the prescribed formatting requirements and page limits.
4. All group members' names and student IDs are accurate.
5. All required in-text citations and references follow the selected APA referencing style.
6. The official marking rubric for the current semester is attached.
7. The compulsory Turnitin Report is included.
8. The assignment is submitted according to the instructions and deadline provided by the lecturer.

Failure to comply with these requirements may result in mark deductions in accordance with the assessment guidelines.

f. Sample Written Assignment

Students may refer to the sample written assignment provided on Moodle for **FORMATTING GUIDANCE ONLY**.

The sample is intended to demonstrate the appropriate assignment structure, formatting, referencing style, and overall presentation.

IMPORTANT: The sample does not represent the assignment questions, content requirements, or assessment criteria for the current semester.

Students must follow the assignment instructions and official marking rubric provided for the current semester.

g. Off-Campus Activities and Safety

- Students are strongly encouraged to complete all assignment-related activities within the university campus.
- Any activities conducted outside the university campus are undertaken **voluntarily and at the students' own risk and responsibility**.
- Students are responsible for ensuring their personal safety and taking all necessary precautions when conducting activities outside the campus.
- **The lecturer and the University shall not be held responsible for any accidents, injuries, losses, damages, or other incidents arising from students' voluntary off-campus activities, to the extent permitted by applicable law and university regulations.**
- Students are advised to exercise caution and make appropriate arrangements to ensure their safety throughout the completion of the assignment.

h. Consultation and Clarification

Students who have questions or require further clarification regarding the assignment requirements are encouraged to approach their lecturer for consultation.

Students are advised to seek clarification **before submitting their assignment** to avoid unnecessary misunderstandings or errors.

APPENDIX 1

MARKING RUBRICS

Component Title						**Percentage (%)**		
Criteria		**Score and Descriptors**					**Weight (%)**	**Marks**
		Excellent	**Good**	**Average**	**Need Improvement**	**Poor**		
		18–20	**14–17**	**10–13**	**5–9**	**0-4**		
1.	**Cultural Transformation in Malaysia**	Insightful explanation and evaluation of selected cultural transformations, with strong connections to contemporary Malaysian society and sustainable development; evidence is effectively integrated.	Clear explanation and relevant evaluation with good connections to Malaysian society/development; some aspects could be developed further.	Basic understanding is evident, but discussion is broad, descriptive or only partly connected to sustainable development.	Limited/inaccurate understanding; transformations are mainly listed or weakly connected to Malaysian society/development.	Very limited or inaccurate understanding; transformations are missing, incorrectly identified, or merely listed with little to no explanation or connection to Malaysian society and development.		**20**
2.	**Political & Economic Transformation**	Comprehensive and well-integrated explanation of selected political/economic transformations with convincing evaluation of their contribution and relevance to Malaysia's development.	Clear and accurate explanation with relevant evaluation and evidence; connections are generally well developed.	Basic explanation is present but tends to be descriptive; evaluation or links to development are only partly developed.	Limited/inaccurate discussion with weak analysis or little meaningful connection to Malaysia's development	Minimal or largely inaccurate discussion; analysis is absent or extremely weak, with little to no meaningful connection to Malaysia's development		**20**
3.	**Malaysia & Sustainable Development**	Priorities/challenges are thoughtfully selected and convincingly evaluated; strong judgement of	Relevant priorities/challenges with clear evaluation and good connections	Relevant issues are identified, but evaluation is general or mainly descriptive.	Issues are unclear, weakly justified or poorly connected to sustainable development.	Issues are missing/irrelevant/inaccurate, with little to no justification or connection.		**20**

		how cultural, political/economic factors affect sustainable development, supported by relevant evidence	to sustainable development.					
4.	**Intercultural Perspectives & Collective Evaluation**	Diverse perspectives are meaningfully integrated; comparisons lead to strong collective judgement of relevance, suitability and adaptation to Malaysia.	Relevant perspectives are compared with clear collaborative evaluation and reasonable judgement of suitability.	Some comparison is evident, but perspectives are discussed somewhat separately or evaluation remains general.	Minimal/superficial intercultural engagement; perspectives are poorly connected to Malaysia or lack collective evaluation.	Little to no intercultural engagement; perspectives are missing, irrelevant, or not meaningfully connected to Malaysia, with little to no collective evaluation.		**20**
		9-10	**7-8**	**4-6**	**3-1**	**0-1**		
5.	**Academic Quality, Evidence & Organization**	Highly coherent, well organized and professionally presented; claims and judgements are supported by credible evidence and appropriate referencing.	Well organized and appropriately supported, with minor weaknesses in evidence, writing or referencing.	Adequate organization and evidence with noticeable inconsistencies.	Poor organization, insufficient credible evidence and/or major academic presentation weaknesses.	Very poor or incoherent organization, little to no credible evidence, and major academic presentation weaknesses that significantly affect the quality and clarity of the work.		**10**
						TOTAL		**90**

Note to students: Please include the marking rubric when submitting your coursework. Failure to attach the marking rubric will result in a 10-mark penalty from the overall written assignment mark.